

# Sasha Tanase Luca

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User Experience Researcher | Web3 | Discovery, PMF & Behavioral Insight



[LinkedIn ↗](#) | [Website ↗](#) | [Twitter ↗](#)

I'm Sasha Tanase Luca, and I do user research for web3 products, mostly around Ethereum and Bitcoin, where discovery and behavioral insight guide every decision. I love digging into what users actually need and turning that into evidence that teams can act on. **To me, great research is one that balances rigorous methodology with real-world messiness, and proves its worth through the decisions it shapes.** I'm at my best when I'm helping teams figure out what really matters, cutting through assumptions, and aligning everyone around user evidence so they can ship something people actually use.

**For over 7 years** I've been leading research programs, validating Product-Market Fit, and uncovering the behavioral patterns that drive product decisions, while navigating the complexity of decentralized systems.

Alongside my research work, I'm an **active public speaker** at major web3 conferences such as Devcon and EthCC. My favorite topics focus on practical perspectives on user research, UX, trust, and developer experience in decentralized systems.

## Core Skills Applied

User Research, Product Discovery, PMF Validation, Jobs-to-be-Done Analysis, Qualitative & Quantitative Methods, User Segmentation, Behavioral Analysis, Insight Synthesis, Usability Testing, Diary Studies, Stakeholder Alignment, Research Repository Management

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## Experience

### Mezo Network - UX Research Manager & Product Strategy

July 2024 - July 2025

[Mezo Network ↗](#)

- Led PMF-focused research for Mezo Network across discovery, segmentation, and value proposition validation. The research identified the exact user segment that consistently responded to Mezo Borrow, while invalidating several lower-fit segments. This sharpened product focus and helped concentrate efforts on the top 35–40% of users most likely to adopt and retain.
- Translated research findings into concrete roadmap decisions in close partnership with the Product Managers responsible for Mezo Borrow and Mezo Onboarding. These insights directly influenced prioritization and helped elevate Mezo Borrow as the flagship product of the Mezo Network, driving the majority of early product engagement within two quarters.
- Built a centralized insight repository used across the company, coordinating across Product, Design, Engineering, and Marketing. The repository became the single source of truth for research, supporting 15+ stakeholders. It streamlined access to research, reduced duplicated efforts, and improved cross-team decision-making. [Repository can be seen here](#)
- Ran Jobs-to-be-Done interviews, PMF surveys, and iterative discovery combining qualitative and quantitative signals. The outputs aligned Product and Marketing around a shared definition of the target user and enabled clearer messaging, contributing to a 20% uplift in qualified traffic and early-stage conversion for Mezo Borrow.

### Web3UX User Research Panel - Co-founder

April 2022 - Now

[Web3UX ↗](#)

- Co-founded Web3UX, now the single owner, a user testing platform built specifically for web3 native users. Created to solve one of the core problems in decentralized product development: access to the right research participants. The platform connected web3 projects with real users for usability testing, discovery research, and behavioral studies.

## Threshold Network - UX Research & Design Lead

September 2021 - July 2024

[Threshold Network ↗](#)

- Led post-merger discovery and stakeholder alignment following the Keep and NuCypher merge. Ran workshops and interviews to define shared product direction and brand identity, resulting in Brand Personality Guidelines, Target User Profiles, and validated product hypotheses. This work helped minimize roadmap rework and improved strategic alignment across teams.
- Conducted deep research into Threshold's core target audience: Bitcoin holders already exposed to DeFi. Validated assumptions around risk tolerance, yield expectations, and trust barriers, narrowing focus to higher-fit user segments. Insights guided product strategy, boosting early adoption of staking and bridging features and driving growth in Total Value Locked (TVL) across these flows.
- Led the end-to-end research and UX strategy for the Threshold marketing website. Defined a segmented information architecture tailored to different user profiles, led user flows, wireframes, and three rounds of usability testing, resulting in a 30% improvement in first-time task success and a 22% lift in product engagement from website entry points.
- Led research for the Threshold Network Dashboard covering onboarding, legacy stake migration, new staker flows, and Node Operator experiences. Ran extensive research with stakers, node operators, service providers, and BTC-focused DeFi users. Research-driven iterations improved onboarding completion by approximately 20% and reduced time-to-first-stake by around 16%.
- Led discovery and iterative validation for the tBTC bridge v2. Ran exploratory research, validated product hypotheses, and collaborated closely with smart contract developers to align UX with protocol constraints. Delivered two validated iterations that improved successful bridge completion rates by approximately 18% and increased user confidence in the bridging process.
- Created a custom research methodology I am very proud of, combining diary studies and interviews to evaluate real-world Node Operator setup and maintenance workflows. This reduced setup-related issues by approximately 30% and improved operator-reported clarity. [Study here](#)

## Keep Network - UX Research & Design Lead

April 2021 - September 2021

[Keep Network ↗](#)

- Ran deep discovery on Node Operator behavior and uncovered a new high-value segment: Staking Providers (B2B). This led to better documentation, clearer node-setup guides, and tighter communication on client-code updates, reducing friction across the entire setup and node maintenance journey. These changes drove a 15% increase in active Node Operators and cut setup drop-offs by 30%.
- Led discovery and validation for Coverage Pools. User interviews revealed that many token holders wanted a lower-risk, passive-income option with less slashing. Acting on this insight, we designed a feature that tapped into idle tokens, ultimately locking 33% of the total supply and driving stronger engagement with network security.
- Led the end-to-end research for Coverage Pools (before AAVE), the first feature of its kind in Ethereum DeFi at the time. Because the concept was completely new, I focused on learnability and recall in my usability testing. By the end of testing, 87% of participants accurately remembered the full 3-step flow, confirming strong comprehension of a complex new feature.

## Selfkey / KYC-chain - UX Researcher & Design Lead

July 2020 - April 2021

- Responsible for conducting User Research Interviews across both explorative and generative phases, using Qualitative and Quantitative methods.
- Organized Discovery Workshops in the early stages of product development and carried out activities to help the Product Team shape future features and products.
- Improved the onboarding and wallet recovery experience for the SelfKey wallet by adding Seed Phrase and Private Key login options, targeting issues specific to blockchain users.
- Worked on products like SelfKey Digital Identity Wallet, Selfkey Staking, SelfKey Marketplace, KeyFi DeFi Aggregator.

## Consensys / Alethio - Head of Design

July 2018 - May 2020

- Responsible for conducting User Research Interviews across both explorative and generative phases, using Qualitative and Quantitative methods.
- Organized UX Workshops to align stakeholders and define problems to solve. Carried out UX activities to involve and engage a large number of players.
- Led the experience, architecture, and interaction design for several of the company's tool flows and digital services, from incipient phase to launch-ready.
- Worked on products like Alethio Block Explorer, Alethio API, Alethio Monitoring (two versions), Alethio Design System and other functionalities of the Ethereum Data Analytics Platform.

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## Selected Talks & Presentations

- [Designing for Trust in Web3: Lessons from the User Research Field](#) - EthCC[7] Cannes, 2025
- [Elevating Developer Experience \(DX\) in web3 - a framework](#) - EthCC[6], Paris, 2023 - collaboration with Daniel Luca

- [The Future of Web3UX - a Paradigm Shift for a Better Collaboration between Design and Development](#) DevCon VI Bogota, 2022
- [Accessibility: Ethereum for LITERALLY everyone!](#) - EthCC[4] Paris, 2022
- [That never even crossed my mind! How to spot & fix your cognitive biases](#) - EthCC[3] 2020, Paris
- [User Research: How to Get Out of Our Bubbles by Talking to Users](#) - DevCon V Osaka, 2019 - collaboration with Georgia Rakusen

## Education

**Master Degree of Architecture (M.Arch)** - Ion Mincu University of Architecture and Urbanism, Bucharest, 2005-2011